



TV/FILM DIRECTOR

JOB DESCRIPTION

Directors oversee the production of a film or TV show, and make the creative decisions that guide the rest of the crew. They link together experts in various disciplines, including actors, costume and set designers, and camera operators, and are ultimately responsible for developing a vision for the TV show or film by defining its overall shape, structure, and style.



SALARY

Independent director ★★★★★
Experienced director ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

A fast-evolving industry • Corporate production is booming • Rise in independent film-making due to affordable film equipment and more investors

CAREER PATHS

There is no formal route to becoming a director, but experience, reputation, and creative energy are all important. Aspiring directors often work on low-budget independent productions early in their careers, and often come from diverse backgrounds, such as acting or screenwriting.

GRADUATE You can study for a degree in film or cinematography, in which you will be taught technical skills in composition, lighting, and direction and develop your creative instincts.

CAMERA OPERATOR If you start your career as a camera operator, you can progress to the senior position of director of photography. From there, you can go on to direct films and TV shows.

PRODUCTION ASSISTANT As a production assistant (or "runner") on a set, you run errands for the production team. Hard work and dedication may earn you promotion to production-based or creative roles, which may lead to an assistant director position.



ASSISTANT DIRECTOR

As the director's second-in-command, you are responsible for all practical tasks, such as managing schedules, allowing the director to fully concentrate on the creative process.

Steven Spielberg and James Cameron, two of the most successful film directors of all time, did not go to film school.